

Day 52 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Justice Party, Growth of Rationalism, Self-Respect Movement, and the Dravidian Movement

READING MATERIAL

Covers the organisational lineage of Tamil Nadu's major 20th-century socio-political movements — Justice Party, the Self-Respect Movement, and the Dravidian movement (Dravida Kazhagam onward) — and the principles distinguishing them, including the growth of rationalism.

Q: Real exam: What are the founding years of the Justice Party, the Self-Respect Movement, Dravida Kazhagam (DK), and the DMK?

A: Justice Party: 1916. Self-Respect Movement: 1925. Dravida Kazhagam (DK): 1944. DMK: 1949 — all four confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question.

Q: Real exam: How did the Justice Party's meetings differ in language from the Indian National Congress's meetings in this period?

A: Justice Party meetings were held in ENGLISH ONLY. The Indian National Congress, by contrast, ALSO held meetings in Tamil specifically to attract and reach common people — both confirmed true by a real exam question, highlighting a key class/elitism distinction between the two organisations at the time.

Q: Real exam: What significant role did Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy hold by 1927?

A: She was elected Deputy Speaker of the (Madras) Legislature in 1927 — confirmed by a real exam question. (She was also independently notable as one of India's pioneering women in public life — the first woman legislator in British India and the first woman in Asia to hold several such distinctions, though those broader facts weren't the specific point tested here.)

Q: Real exam: Where was the first state-level meet of the Self-Respect Movement conducted?

A: Chengalpet — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: How did Periyar form the Dravida Kazhagam (DK), and in what year did the Vaikom Satyagraha arise?

A: Periyar incorporated the ideas of the Justice Party to form Dravida Kazhagam (1944) — confirmed by a real exam question, showing DK's direct ideological lineage from the Justice Party. Separately, the Vaikom Satyagraha arose in Kerala in 1924 — also confirmed by a real exam question (re-affirming the year already used in the Unit III Satyagraha topic).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In which year was the Justice Party founded?

A. 1916 ✓

B. 1925

C. 1944

D. 1949

Explanation: 1916. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. In which year was the Self-Respect Movement founded?

A. 1916

B. 1925 ✓

C. 1944

D. 1949

Explanation: 1925. [medium, question-bank-2025]

3. In which year was Dravida Kazhagam (DK) founded?

A. 1916

B. 1925

C. 1944 ✓

D. 1949

Explanation: 1944. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. In which year was the DMK founded?

A. 1916

- B. 1925
- C. 1944
- D. 1949 ✓**

Explanation: 1949. [medium, question-bank-2025]

5. Real exam: In what language were Justice Party meetings generally held?

- A. Tamil only
- B. English only ✓**
- C. Both Tamil and English equally
- D. Sanskrit

Explanation: English only. [hard, question-bank-2025]

6. Why did the Indian National Congress also hold meetings in Tamil during this period?

- A. To compete with the British administration
- B. To attract and reach common people ✓**
- C. Because English was banned
- D. To follow Gandhi's personal instruction

Explanation: To attract and reach common people. [medium, question-bank-2025]

7. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy was elected Deputy Speaker of the Madras Legislature in:

- A. 1916
- B. 1924
- C. 1927 ✓**
- D. 1944

Explanation: 1927. [hard, question-bank-2025]

8. The first state-level meet of the Self-Respect Movement was conducted at:

- A. Chengalpet ✓**
- B. Madurai
- C. Chennai
- D. Kovai

Explanation: Chengalpet. [hard, question-bank-2025]

9. Periyar formed Dravida Kazhagam by incorporating the ideas of which earlier organisation?

- A. Indian National Congress
- B. Justice Party ✓**
- C. Self-Respect Movement alone, with no other influence
- D. Swatantra Party

Explanation: Justice Party. [medium, question-bank-2017]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Lowest Common Multiple (LCM)

READING MATERIAL

LCM is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows two distinct shapes: algebraic LCM-from-a-clue problems, and 'remainder' word problems — both are taught below as separate methods.

Q: Real exam (2025): If the LCM of 'a' and 'a+2' is 1300, find the LCM of 'a' and 'a+1'.

A: Since a and a+2 differ by 2, their HCF is either 1 or 2. If $\text{HCF}=2$: $\text{LCM} = a(a+2)/2 = 1300 \rightarrow a(a+2) = 2600$. Solving $a^2+2a-2600=0$ gives $a=50$ (check: $50 \times 52/2 = 1300$ ✓). Now find $\text{LCM}(50, 51)$: consecutive integers are always coprime ($\text{HCF}=1$), so $\text{LCM} = 50 \times 51 = 2550$.

Q: Method — 'least number leaving given remainders' (remainders differ from the divisors by a constant): Find the least number which, when divided by 16, 18, and 21, leaves remainders 3, 5, and 8 respectively.

A: Check the gap between each divisor and its remainder: $16-3=13$, $18-5=13$, $21-8=13$ — all the same gap! When that happens, the answer is $\text{LCM}(16,18,21) - 13$. $\text{LCM}(16,18,21) = 1008$. Answer = $1008-13 = 995$.

Q: Method — 'least number leaving the SAME remainder in every case': Find the least number which, when divided by 6, 7, 8, 9, and 12, leaves the same remainder 1 in every case.

A: When the remainder is identical across all divisors, the answer is $\text{LCM}(\text{divisors}) + \text{remainder}$. $\text{LCM}(6,7,8,9,12) = 504$. Answer = $504 + 1 = 505$.

Q: Method — 'mixed condition' (a common remainder for some divisors, but exact division for another): Find the least number which, when divided by 5, 6, 7, and 8, leaves remainder 3 in each case, but leaves NO remainder when divided by 9.

A: First find the least number leaving remainder 3 for 5,6,7,8: that's $\text{LCM}(5,6,7,8)+3 = 840+3 = 843$. But we also need it divisible by 9. Keep adding $\text{LCM}(5,6,7,8)=840$ repeatedly to 843 until the result is divisible by 9: 843 (no), 1683 ($1683 \div 9 = 187$, yes!). Answer = 1683.

Q: Method — LCM of numbers given as prime factorizations: Find the LCM of $(2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7)$ and $(3 \times 5 \times 7 \times 11)$.

A: LCM takes the HIGHEST power of every prime that appears in either number. Primes involved: 2,3,5,7,11 — each appears at most once in either factorization, so $\text{LCM} = 2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7 \times 11$ (just the union of all prime factors, since none repeat).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If the LCM of 'b' and 'b+2' is 180, and their HCF is 2, find the LCM of 'b' and 'b+1'.

A. 342 ✓

B. 380

C. 361

D. 324

Explanation: $\text{LCM} = b(b+2)/\text{HCF} = 180 \rightarrow b(b+2) = 360 \rightarrow b^2+2b-360=0 \rightarrow b=18$ (check: $18 \times 20/2 = 180$ ✓). Now $\text{LCM}(18,19)$: consecutive integers are coprime, so $\text{LCM} = 18 \times 19 = 342$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the least number which, when divided by 12, 15, and 20, leaves remainders 7, 10, and 15 respectively.

A. 55 ✓

B. 60

C. 65

D. 53

Explanation: Gaps: $12-7=5$, $15-10=5$, $20-15=5$ — all equal, so answer = $\text{LCM}(12,15,20) - 5 = 60 - 5 = 55$. [medium, authored]

3. Find the least number which, when divided by 4, 5, and 6, leaves the same remainder 2 in each case.

A. 58

B. 60

C. 62 ✓

D. 64

Explanation: $\text{LCM}(4,5,6) = 60$. Answer = $60 + 2 = 62$. [easy, authored]

4. Find the LCM of $(2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 5)$ and $(2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 7)$.

A. $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$ ✓

B. $2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$

C. $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$

D. $4 \times 9 \times 5 \times 7$

Explanation: Take the highest power of each prime: 2^2 (from the first), 3^2 (from the second), 5^1 , 7^1 . $\text{LCM} = 2^2 \times 3^2 \times 5 \times 7$, which equals option (A) written out as $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$. [medium, authored]

5. The LCM of two consecutive integers n and $n+1$ is always:

A. $n + 1$

B. $n(n+1)$ ✓

C. $n - 1$

D. Cannot be determined

Explanation: Consecutive integers are always coprime ($\text{HCF}=1$), so their LCM is simply their product, $n(n+1)$. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Wind on Haunted Hill" — Ruskin Bond

READING MATERIAL

Set in the Himalayan hills, this story follows Usha, a brave and practical girl unafraid of the local 'haunted' ruins, on a day that begins with household chores and a shopping trip across the hill to the bazaar.

Q: Where is the story set, and what is the name of the central girl character?

A: In the Himalayan hills. The girl's name is Usha.

Q: What were the children doing at the beginning of the story, and what was used to hold the clothes down?

A: Spreading clothes out to dry. Stones were used to hold the clothes down (presumably against the hill wind).

Q: Who was always eager to visit the bazaar, and why did he NOT go this time?

A: Suresh was always ready to visit the bazaar — but this time he couldn't go because he had to chop wood.

Q: Why was Usha not afraid of ghosts, despite the hill's reputation for being haunted?

A: Because she believed ghosts don't come out during the daytime — a simple, practical reasoning rather than any special charm or protection.

Q: Where did Usha go shopping, what did she buy for herself, and what colour was it?

A: She went to the bazaar across the hill. She bought herself a necklace, coloured AMBER.

Q: What did Usha get repaired at the cobbler's, and what bird sang in the ruins?

A: She got her MOTHER's slippers repaired at the cobbler's (not her own). A Whistling Thrush sang in the ruins.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Wind on Haunted Hill" is set in:

- A. A desert
- B. A coastal town
- C. The Himalayan hills ✓**
- D. An island village

Explanation: The Himalayan hills. [easy, web-research]

2. What is the name of the central girl character in the story?

- A. Radha
- B. Usha ✓**
- C. Meena
- D. Lakshmi

Explanation: Usha. [easy, web-research]

3. What were the children doing at the start of the story?

- A. Flying kites
- B. Collecting wood
- C. Spreading clothes to dry ✓**
- D. Playing cricket

Explanation: Spreading clothes to dry. [medium, web-research]

4. What was used to hold the drying clothes down?

- A. Nails
- B. Bricks
- C. Leaves
- D. Stones ✓**

Explanation: Stones. [medium, web-research]

5. Why didn't Suresh go to the bazaar this time, even though he usually loved to?

- A. He was ill
- B. He had school

C. He had to chop wood ✓

D. He was afraid

Explanation: He had to chop wood. [medium, web-research]

6. Why was Usha not afraid of ghosts?

A. She had a protective charm

B. She had a dog with her

C. Ghosts don't come out in the daytime ✓

D. She believed she could fly away

Explanation: Ghosts don't come out in the daytime. [medium, web-research]

7. What did Usha buy for herself at the bazaar, and what colour was it?

A. Red bangles

B. An amber necklace ✓

C. Silver earrings

D. A green anklet

Explanation: An amber necklace. [medium, web-research]

8. What did Usha get repaired at the cobbler's?

A. Her own bag

B. Her own shoes

C. Her own slippers

D. Her mother's slippers ✓

Explanation: Her mother's slippers. [hard, web-research]

9. What bird sang in the ruins on the hill?

A. Nightingale

B. Sparrow

C. Whistling Thrush ✓

D. Crow

Explanation: Whistling Thrush. [hard, web-research]